

The Bills Even His Own Party Supported

Steve Weir (R-Hebron), Connecticut House 55th District · 2023 through May 2026 · The 94 bills where Rep. Weir voted "no" while a majority of House Republicans voted "yes"

A personal report by Scott Sauyet · scott@sauyet.com · Not an official document

Compiled May 9, 2026 from Connecticut General Assembly roll-call records covering the 2023, 2024, 2025, and 2026 regular sessions. This report focuses on a single, narrow pattern: bills where Rep. Steve Weir voted "no" while a majority of his own party's caucus voted "yes." It is a companion to the broader [voting record analysis](#), which establishes that Weir voted with the Republican caucus position on 96.4% of partisan roll calls. The pattern documented here describes the remaining cases — votes where Weir broke from his caucus, but in the opposite direction from what bipartisanship would imply.

INTRODUCTION

Overview

Across four sessions of the Connecticut House of Representatives, Rep. Steve Weir voted with his own party's majority on contested questions 96.4% of the time. The companion report [Steve Weir's Voting Record](http://andoverct.info/reports/55th/weir-analysis/) (<http://andoverct.info/reports/55th/weir-analysis/>) covers that pattern in detail, including issue-by-issue alignment and the rare crossover votes.

This report addresses a different question. When Weir *did* break from his caucus, in which direction did he break?

The answer, in 1,293 roll calls: he broke to the right of his caucus on 95 occasions (94 unique bills), and to the left of his caucus only 3 times.

That 95-to-3 ratio is the subject of this report. Specifically: when a majority of House Republicans voted "yes" on a bill — including bills they treated as routine, technical, or bipartisan — what bills did Weir nonetheless vote "no" on?

The list is not what one would expect from a small-government conservative dissenting on principled grounds. It includes child-safety regulations, judicial confirmations to seats long held without incident, Uniform Commercial Code housekeeping, conveyances of state land to municipalities, resolutions honoring military veterans, and the enforcement of boating laws on shared interstate waters.

This report walks through the patterns visible in those 94 bills.

FINDINGS

Part 1 — The headline numbers

The 95-to-3 ratio ✓ *Confirmed from CGA roll-call records, 2023–2026*

Direction of break	Roll calls
Weir voted "no" while R caucus majority voted "yes"	95
Weir voted "yes" while R caucus majority voted "no" and D caucus voted strongly "yes" (genuine crossover)	3
Net direction of breaks from caucus	+92 right

Notes: The right-of-caucus category requires that the Republican caucus had at least 10 members voting and that more Republicans voted yes than no. The crossover category is more demanding: it requires the Democratic caucus to have voted yes by at least 85% and the Republican caucus to have voted no by at least 70%. The asymmetry reflects the rarity of genuine crossover behavior in the dataset. Source: Connecticut General Assembly roll-call PDFs.

The 95 right-of-caucus roll calls cover 94 unique bills (one bill produced two roll calls, both no votes). For brevity, the rest of this report refers to "94 bills."

The three crossover votes — bills Weir supported despite Republican caucus opposition — were:

- **HB-6738 (2023)** — Compassionate or medical parole and emergency-related release credits
- **SB-913 (2023)** — Expanding workers' compensation coverage for post-traumatic stress injuries to all employees
- **HR-15 (2025)** — A collective bargaining agreement between Charter Oak State College and a UAW local

The remaining 94 bills are the focus of this report.

Part 2 — The bills where Weir was the most isolated

These are the bills where Weir's own caucus voted yes most overwhelmingly while he voted no. The "R vote" column shows Republican caucus members' yes-no count. The higher the yes count, the more isolated Weir was within his own party on that vote.

Bills with Republican support of 85% or higher ✓ *Confirmed*

Year	Bill	R vote	Title
2024	HB-5350	52–1	Boating-law enforcement near RI/MA/NY borders (Weir was the lone R "no")
2025	HJ-31	45–2	Confirming Hon. Elizabeth A. Bozzuto to be a Superior Court judge
2025	HB-6970	46–3	Adoption of amendments to the Uniform Commercial Code
2023	SB-905	49–4	Alcoholic liquor permits and tobacco bars
2026	HB-5467	45–4	DECD employee designated for concierge services to small businesses
2025	HJ-38	43–4	Confirming Hon. Margaret M. Murphy to be a Superior Court judge
2023	HR-31	49–5	State Police Union (NP-1) stipulated agreement
2024	HB-5196	48–5	Expanding the podiatric scope of practice
2025	HB-6438	43–5	Recognizing and honoring military service of CT veterans
2025	HJ-30	41–5	Confirming Hon. Barry F. Armata to be a Superior Court judge
2025	SJ-28	40–5	Confirming Hon. Gerard I. Adelman to be a State Referee
2025	SB-1336	42–6	Mortgage foreclosures and undischarged mortgages
2025	HB-5572	42–6	Real estate wholesaler regulation
2025	HB-7281	42–6	Conveyance of state land to the Town of Southbury (amendment of prior conveyance)
2023	SB-1069	47–7	Domestic-animal-related statute revisions
2025	SB-1179	40–6	Connecticut Community Makerspace Initiative Program
2025	SJ-27	39–6	Confirming Hon. Holly Abery-Wetstone to be a State Referee
2025	HB-7233	40–7	Establishing a Parkinson's Disease Research Account

Notes: These 18 bills are the most striking subset of the 94 — votes where, on plain partisan-loyalty grounds, almost every Republican supported the bill and Weir alone (or nearly alone) opposed it. Several are routine procedural matters where opposition is not, so far as the bill text reveals, ideologically motivated. Source: CGA roll-call PDFs.

The full list of 94 bills, with vote counts and links to the official roll-call PDFs, is available as a downloadable spreadsheet — see the Other Formats section at the end of this report.

ANALYSIS

Part 3 — Categorical patterns

The 94 bills are not a random scatter. They cluster around several recognizable categories.

Judicial confirmations (9 bills)

Weir voted no on 15 of 75 judicial and state referee nominations during this period — a rate of opposition far higher than typical for a member of his caucus. Several of those no votes came on confirmations the Republican caucus broadly supported:

- **HJ-31 (2025)** — Hon. Elizabeth A. Bozzuto to Superior Court (142–3, R caucus 45–2)
- **HJ-38 (2025)** — Hon. Margaret M. Murphy to Superior Court (139–6, R caucus 43–4)
- **HJ-30 (2025)** — Hon. Barry F. Armata to Superior Court (132–12, R caucus 41–5)
- **SJ-28 (2025)** — Hon. Gerard I. Adelman to be a State Referee (126–12, R caucus 40–5)
- **SJ-27 (2025)** — Hon. Holly Abery-Wetstone to be a State Referee (126–15, R caucus 39–6)
- **HJ-70 (2025)** — David A. Arconti, Jr. to PURA Utility Commissioner (136–9, R caucus 37–9)
- **SJ-79 (2025)** — Devaughn L. Ward to Correction Ombuds (126–9, R caucus 38–9)
- **HJ-20 (2024)** — Nicholas Kapoor to the Commission on Human Rights and Opportunities (122–24, R caucus 29–24)
- **SJ-195 (2024)** — Hon. Pedro E. Segarra to Superior Court (125–23, R caucus 31–23)

The clustering of these votes in a single year (2025) is notable. Most are uncontroversial confirmations where the Republican caucus voted yes by 80% or more. Routine professional review of judicial nominees does not typically produce that pattern of opposition from a single member.

State employee bargaining agreements (6 bills)

The Connecticut Constitution requires legislative ratification of contracts negotiated between the executive branch and state employee unions. These ratification votes are typically opposed by a minority of the Republican caucus on principle, and supported by the rest. Weir consistently voted with the harder-right minority — including in cases where his caucus's majority went the other way:

- **HR-31 (2023)** — State Police Union (NP-1) stipulated agreement (143–5, R caucus 49–5)
- **HJ-36 (2023)** — Confirmation of Benjamin Blake as a Workers' Compensation Administrative Law Judge (132–12, R caucus 39–12)
- **HR-26 (2023)** — Interest arbitration award between the state and SEBAC (129–15, R caucus 36–15)
- **HR-17 (2025)** — Agreement between the state and the Connecticut State Police Union (134–12, R caucus 36–12)
- **HR-14 (2024)** — Agreement between UConn and a UAW local (126–24, R caucus 30–24)
- **HR-3 (2026)** — Arbitration award between the Judicial Branch and various employee unions (126–16, R caucus 31–16)

As Ranking Member of the Labor and Public Employees Committee, Weir's no votes on these agreements carry additional weight. He is in a structural position to influence his caucus's stance on labor questions, and his dissents have consistently been to the more anti-labor end of the available options.

State-land conveyances and routine governance (8 bills)

Conveyances of state-owned land to specific municipalities — bills that ordinarily pass with broad bipartisan support — drew Weir no votes throughout 2023, 2025, and 2026:

- **HB-7280 (2025)** — Conveying a parcel of state land to the City of Danbury (132–11, R caucus 36–11)
- **HB-7281 (2025)** — Amending a prior conveyance to the Town of Southbury (136–8, R caucus 42–6)
- **HB-7284 (2025)** — Conveying a parcel of state land to the Town of Preston (126–18, R caucus 34–14)
- **SB-1566 (2025)** — Conveying a parcel of state land to the Town of Cheshire (133–14, R caucus 33–14)
- **HB-6939 (2023)** — Conveying parcels of state land to the City of New Haven (124–25, R caucus 28–25)
- **HB-6937 (2023)** — Amending a conveyance of state land to the New Haven Port Authority (130–18, R caucus 36–18)

Other procedural and routine governance items in the same pattern:

- **HB-7000 (2025)** — Implementing OPM recommendations on the State Plan of Conservation and Development (136–12, R caucus 36–12)
- **SJ-1 (2023)** — Resolution concerning the joint rules of the Senate and House (135–10, R caucus 43–10)

These are the kind of bills that legislators typically vote yes on without controversy because they are local, technical, or organizational. The opposition pattern is unusual.

Public-health and child-safety measures (12 bills)

A category that should be especially difficult to dissent from on principled small-government grounds:

- **HB-6678 (2023)** — Nursing home transparency (128–10, R caucus 42–10)
- **HB-6587 (2023)** — A *task-force study* on Medicaid coverage of diapers and other health-related social needs (129–16, R caucus 35–16)
- **HB-6573 (2023)** — Access to diaper-changing tables in public buildings (119–23, R caucus 29–23)
- **HB-6731 (2023)** — DPH recommendations on change-of-ownership for health-care facilities (130–18, R caucus 35–18)
- **HB-6900 (2023)** — Children’s behavioral health policy and planning committee (125–23, R caucus 31–23)
- **HB-6951 (2025)** — Children’s behavioral health services (118–28, R caucus 24–23)
- **SB-181 (2024)** — Emergency department crowding (140–9, R caucus 44–9)
- **HB-5196 (2024)** — Expanding the podiatric scope of practice (132–16, R caucus 48–5)
- **HB-5290 (2024)** — Various revisions to the public-health statutes (131–16, R caucus 37–16)
- **HB-5411 (2024)** — Requests for health records and the fees charged for access (126–23, R caucus 30–23)
- **SB-196 (2026)** — Hospital sale-leaseback agreements and private-equity controls (130–18, R caucus 31–18)
- **SB-452 (2026)** — Release of lighter-than-air balloons (a wildlife/safety measure; 124–24, R caucus 26–24)

The 2023 bill on Medicaid coverage of diapers warrants individual attention because it was a *study* — a task force directed to research the question, not a regulation creating coverage. Even on this preliminary, study-only measure, Weir voted no while two-thirds of his caucus voted yes.

Reproductive rights

The reproductive-rights bill in this list is striking because the Republican caucus narrowly voted yes — meaning Weir was opposing legislation his own caucus’s majority supported, not just legislation the Democratic majority supported.

- **HB-7213 (2025)** — Access to reproductive health care (117–27, R caucus 25–23)

Environment and clean energy (6 bills)

In addition to the broader environmental record covered in the [companion report](http://andoverct.info/reports/55th/weir-analysis/) (<http://andoverct.info/reports/55th/weir-analysis/>), several environmental and energy-siting bills drew right-of-caucus opposition:

- **HB-6805 (2023)** — Solar installations in condominiums and cooperatives (136–12, R caucus 41–11)
- **HB-6851 (2023)** — Recommendations of the Hydrogen Task Force (126–12, R caucus 41–12)
- **HB-5361 (2024)** — Siting of renewable energy sources in the state (119–30, R caucus 42–12)
- **SB-293 (2024)** — Redemption of out-of-state beverage containers (129–19, R caucus 34–19)
- **HB-5157 (2026)** — Tire stewardship program (124–21, R caucus 29–21)
- **HB-5145 (2026)** — Public hearing requirement for water companies seeking to cease operations (128–20, R caucus 33–17)

Economic development and small business (10 bills)

A particularly surprising cluster, given Weir’s stated platform emphasizes business-friendly economic policy and his recent role as Chair of the CT River Valley Chamber of Commerce:

- **SB-1027 (2023)** — DECD recommendations on the JobsCT Tax Rebate Program and aerospace manufacturing projects (140–9, R caucus 45–8)
- **SB-1042 (2023)** — DECD capacity-building grants to brownfield land banks (137–12, R caucus 42–12)
- **SB-13 (2024)** — Incentivizing student-loan repayment assistance (133–12, R caucus 41–12)
- **SB-121 (2024)** — Attorney General, Banking Commissioner, and Dodd-Frank Wall Street Reform provisions (130–13, R caucus 38–13)
- **SB-1295 (2025)** — Broadband internet, gaming, social media, and consumer contracts (127–15, R caucus 32–15)
- **SB-1179 (2025)** — Connecticut Community Makerspace Initiative Program (139–6, R caucus 40–6)
- **HB-7233 (2025)** — Parkinson’s Disease Research Account (141–7, R caucus 40–7)
- **HB-6957 (2025)** — A “Resolution Act” passed by the chamber (134–9, R caucus 40–7)
- **HB-5467 (2026)** — DECD employee designated for concierge services to small businesses (143–4, R caucus 45–4)
- **SB-488 (2026)** — Treasurer’s recommendations for the Unclaimed Property Program and Second Injury Fund (127–22, R caucus 28–22)

The DECD concierge-services bill (HB-5467, 2026) — providing a single point of contact within the state’s economic development department to help small businesses navigate state regulations — is exactly the kind of business-friendly, government-efficiency measure that one would expect a former Chamber of Commerce chair to support. Weir voted no.

Education (6 bills)

- **HB-6689 (2023)** — Higher education supplemental loan refinance subsidy for health-care professionals (121–23, R caucus 27–23)
- **SB-1165 (2023)** — Financial literacy instruction (138–12, R caucus 42–12)
- **HB-6762 (2023)** — Early childhood education, mastery exam audit, civics task force, special education, multilingual learner bill of rights (129–19, R caucus 35–19)
- **HB-6882 (2023)** — Education mandate relief and various technical revisions (133–17, R caucus 37–17)
- **HB-5437 (2024)** — Education mandate relief, school discipline, and disconnected youth (129–20, R caucus 32–20)
- **HB-5003 (2025)** — Early childhood care and education (133–10, R caucus 36–10)

Civil rights and antidiscrimination (2 bills)

The Republican caucus voted yes on both. Weir voted no on both.

- **HB-6638 (2023)** — Revising the state’s antidiscrimination statutes (132–17, R caucus 36–17)
- **HB-6866 (2023)** — Studying nonbinary gender options on state forms (115–26, R caucus 27–26)

The miscellaneous/symbolic category (7 bills)

These are the bills hardest to explain on any consistent ideological grounds:

- **HB-5350 (2024)** — Boating-law enforcement near RI/MA/NY borders. R caucus voted **52–1** in favor. Weir was the **one** Republican voting no.
- **HB-6970 (2025)** — Adoption of amendments to the Uniform Commercial Code. R caucus 46–3. Routine statutory housekeeping that virtually never draws partisan opposition.
- **SB-905 (2023)** — Alcoholic liquor permits and tobacco bars. R caucus 49–4.
- **HB-6438 (2025)** — Recognizing and honoring military service of CT veterans. R caucus 43–5.
- **HB-5333 (2026)** — Striped bass fishing regulation and wildlife conservation. R caucus 41–7.
- **HB-5304 (2024)** — Designating the state dog and state candy. R caucus 35–17. (The 17 nos here may reflect general distaste for symbolic bills, but the broader caucus still favored it.)
- **HB-5409 (2024)** — Designating various days, weeks, and months. R caucus 36–16.

These bills do not align with any recognizable ideological position. They are technical, ceremonial, or statutory-housekeeping measures.

Part 4 — What this pattern suggests

Two interpretations are worth considering, and the data is consistent with a combination of both.

The “principled small-government dissent” interpretation

A legislator might oppose state-land conveyances on the grounds that the state should retain its property. They might oppose state employee union agreements on the grounds that public-sector collective bargaining is too generous. They might oppose health-care or public-safety regulations on the grounds that government over-regulates these areas. None of these positions is unreasonable in itself.

But a principled small-government dissenter would typically apply the principle consistently — including, for example, on bills they vote yes on. It is difficult to identify a coherent small-government rule under which Weir would vote against the boating-law enforcement bill (HB-5350, 2024), the UCC amendments (HB-6970, 2025), or the resolution honoring military veterans (HB-6438, 2025), but not against the hundreds of other routine bills where he voted with his caucus.

The principled dissent also fails to explain the pattern on judicial confirmations. Weir does not vote against all judicial nominees — he voted yes on 60 of 75. The 15 he voted no on are not concentrated in any obviously controversial category.

The “reflexive opposition” interpretation

The alternative interpretation is that Weir’s no votes on these bills are not driven by individual analysis of the bills themselves, but by a default position of opposition to legislation produced by the Democratic majority. On most bills, his caucus colleagues calibrate this default — they recognize routine governance, they recognize technical housekeeping, they recognize bills that warrant a yes vote even if the bill’s sponsor is from the other party. Weir does so less often.

This interpretation is consistent with the boating-law vote (out of 53 voting Republicans, only Weir voted no), the UCC vote, the veterans’ resolution, and the broader cluster of bills with high R-yes percentages. It is also consistent with the fact that 96.4% of Weir’s partisan votes align with his caucus position — high R-alignment is what one would expect from reflexive party-line voting.

The data does not allow a definitive choice between these interpretations. What it does allow is the observation that the 94 bills cataloged here are, as a set, more easily explained by reflexive opposition than by principled small-government dissent. The principled-dissent reading would require a consistent rule that the bills themselves do not appear to share.

Summary table

Question	Answer
Total roll calls 2023–2026	1,293
Right-of-caucus roll calls (Weir N, R majority Y)	95
Unique bills behind those roll calls	94
Genuine crossover votes ($D \geq 85\%$ Y, $R \leq 30\%$ Y, Weir Y)	3
Right-of-caucus to crossover ratio	32:1
Most-isolated vote	HB-5350 (2024) — boating-law enforcement; R caucus 52–1
Judicial / state-referee nominations Weir opposed	15 of 75 (vs. caucus, which supported most overwhelmingly)
Right-of-caucus state-land conveyances	6 (Danbury, Preston, Southbury, Cheshire, New Haven × 2)
Right-of-caucus state employee union agreements	6 (NP-1, NP-2, SEBAC, UConn UAW, Judicial Branch, etc.)
Right-of-caucus public-health and child-safety bills	12 (including diaper-coverage study, ED crowding, nursing-home transparency)

ANALYSIS

Key observations

The 95-to-3 ratio is the headline. When Weir broke from his caucus, he broke right at 32 times the rate he broke left. This is not statistical noise; it is a sustained pattern across four sessions and 1,293 votes.

The bills involved are often uncontroversial. A small-government conservative might plausibly oppose, say, expanded reproductive-rights legislation on principled grounds. The bills cataloged here are largely not that. They are judicial confirmations, conveyances of state land to municipalities, statutory housekeeping, public-health task forces, and resolutions honoring veterans. These are not the bills one expects to find a single legislator's name on the no side.

The “lone Republican” vote is particularly notable. On HB-5350 (2024), the boating-law enforcement bill, every other Republican in the chamber voted yes. Weir was the lone no. There is no record of a public statement explaining the dissent.

The cluster of right-of-caucus judicial confirmations is unusual. Republicans across the country do sometimes vote against individual judicial nominees on grounds of judicial philosophy, but a sustained pattern of opposition to confirmations the rest of the caucus supports overwhelmingly is uncommon. Weir voted no on judges his caucus confirmed by margins of 45–2, 43–4, and 41–5.

The pattern conflicts with Weir’s stated platform on multiple specific points. As immediate past Chair of the CT River Valley Chamber of Commerce, Weir voted no on a DECD bill creating a small-business concierge service that his caucus supported 45–4. As Ranking Member of the Labor and Public Employees Committee, he voted no on labor agreements his caucus’s majority supported. As a self-described supporter of “limiting government intrusion,” he voted no on a bill removing intrusive municipal restrictions on multifamily housing.

Reproductive rights belong in this list now. HB-7213 (2025), the access-to-reproductive-health-care bill, drew Republican caucus support of 25–23 — narrowly in favor. Weir’s no vote put him to the right of his own caucus’s majority on a high-profile question, not just to the right of Democrats.

The interpretive question matters more than the count. The 94 bills could be cataloged as evidence of either principled dissent or reflexive opposition. A reader who concludes the former should be able to identify the consistent principle that ties them together; this report has not been able to. A reader who concludes the latter has the empirical pattern on their side: the bills’ ideological diversity and procedural-routine character are more easily explained by a default-no posture than by any coherent policy framework.

CAVEATS

What this report does not show

This report focuses narrowly on the 94 bills where Weir voted “no” while a majority of House Republicans voted “yes.” It does not address:

- **The 1,198 other roll calls** in the dataset, where Weir voted with his caucus’s position. The companion report, [Steve Weir’s Voting Record](http://andoverct.info/reports/55th/weir-analysis/) (<http://andoverct.info/reports/55th/weir-analysis/>), covers that broader pattern.
- **Why Weir voted no on each bill.** The dataset captures votes, not justifications. Weir may have given floor speeches or issued press releases explaining specific dissents; that material would need to be gathered separately.
- **Whether other Republicans share Weir’s pattern.** A small number of his caucus colleagues — those who appear in the no column on the same bills — also vote in this manner. A peer-comparison analysis

would identify whether Weir is an outlier within his own caucus or merely a member of a small dissenting wing.

- **Bills that died before reaching a roll call.** Some of the most ideologically charged proposals never get to the House floor. The 94 bills in this report are bills the chamber voted on; they do not reflect the universe of bills under consideration.
 - **The legislative significance of any specific dissent.** Weir's no vote on a bill the caucus passed 45–2 had no effect on the outcome. The pattern documented here is descriptive of his voting behavior, not of the laws Connecticut ultimately enacted.
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DOCUMENTATION

Sources

Vote records:

- Connecticut General Assembly roll-call records, 2023, 2024, 2025, and 2026 regular sessions
- [Connecticut General Assembly bill-tracking system](https://www.cga.ct.gov/asp/menu/CGAFindIt.asp) (<https://www.cga.ct.gov/asp/menu/CGAFindIt.asp>)
- Individual roll-call PDFs are linked from each row of the accompanying spreadsheet (see Other Formats, below)

Companion report:

- [Steve Weir's Voting Record](http://andoverct.info/reports/55th/weir-analysis/) (<http://andoverct.info/reports/55th/weir-analysis/>) — broader pattern analysis covering all 1,293 roll calls

Biographical and platform information:

- [State Rep. Steve Weir's official page at the CT House Republicans site](https://www.cthousegop.com/weir/about) (<https://www.cthousegop.com/weir/about>)
 - [Weir's campaign site, steveweirforct.com](https://steveweirforct.com/) (<https://steveweirforct.com/>)
 - [Connecticut General Assembly member page](https://www.cga.ct.gov/asp/CGABillStatus/CGAMemberBills.asp?dist_code=055) (https://www.cga.ct.gov/asp/CGABillStatus/CGAMemberBills.asp?dist_code=055)
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Other Formats

This report is available in four formats, all located alongside this page:



HTML

Interactive version with formatted tables; best for on-screen reading and sharing.



Markdown

Plain-text version; readable in any editor, ideal for copying into other documents.



PDF

Print-ready version with all tables, footnotes, and source citations.



Excel

The full list of 95 right-of-caucus roll calls with bill numbers, dates, vote counts, and links to each roll-call PDF.

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*Compiled May 9, 2026 · Data from Connecticut General Assembly roll-call records.
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